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THIS WEEK'S MACRO ENVIRONMENT

Market Pulse — Live Data

SECTION 1 - MARKET OBSERVATION India VIX at 11.8 is firmly in low-volatility territory, suggesting the market is not pricing in near-term stress, which historically has been a reasonable environment for patient, long-term positioning rather than tactical trading. FII flows came in positive at Rs 920 crore this week, a modest but directionally supportive signal for large-cap Indian equities. The macro signal is NEUTRAL and position sizing is at 100%, meaning there is no systemic reason to be defensive right now. For a 30% bracket investor, a low-VIX, FII-supported environment is precisely when sitting in quality positions and letting compounding work tends to be more tax-efficient than churning for short-term gains that would be taxed at the full slab rate.

Indicator	Value	Signal
India VIX	11.8	LOW
Nifty 50	+0.4%	Up
Crude (Brent)	\$72.1	+0.5%
USD/INR	Rs 95.20	-0.23%
FII flows	Rs 920 Cr	inflow

THIS WEEK'S RESEARCH OBSERVATION

NMDC — HIGH ATTENTION

The following is my personal observation based on publicly available information. Not a recommendation to transact in any security.

SECTION 2 - TOP STOCK OBSERVATION NMDC leads the factor screen this week with a score of 84 out of 100 and a HIGH ATTENTION signal, making it the single most notable research observation from this week's screen. At a PE of just 10.08x and a 3-month momentum of plus 9.2 percent, it sits in what the screen identifies as an RSI 42 recovery zone, meaning price has pulled back but fundamental drivers including low debt and revenue acceleration remain intact. The metals and mining sector in India has a direct linkage to domestic infrastructure and steel demand cycles, and NMDC as a state-backed iron ore producer tends to be relatively insulated from the kind of earnings volatility that makes low-PE readings misleading in private-sector peers. The LTCG angle is directly relevant here: at the 30% income bracket, any gain realised within 12 months on an equity holding is taxed at 20 percent as STCG, whereas holding beyond 12 months brings that rate down to 12.5 percent on gains above Rs 1.25 lakh under current LTCG rules, a meaningful difference when the stock is already showing early momentum at plus 9.2 percent over three months. This is a personal observation and not investment advice.

NMDC · NSE	My note: HIGH ATTENTION
Sector: Metals & Mining · July 04, 2026	Tax note: 12-month hold qualifies for LTCG rate
Score: 84/100 PE: 10.082644x RSI: 42 3m momentum: +9.2%	Outcome review: July 2027

I will report back on this observation in a future brief — including if I was wrong. Every observation is logged publicly with a date and reviewed at the outcome horizon.

Actions on my tax checklist this month.

Action	Deadline	Why it matters
Quarterly Compliance Review Due — Q2 2026	Within first 2 weeks of July 2026	Time to review SEBI regulations for your research platform. New circulars m

ONE THING I AM WATCHING

Next week's key event or data point.

SECTION 3 - ONE THING TO WATCH China's monthly iron ore import and industrial output data, typically released in the second week of July, is the single most important external variable for NMDC and the broader metals screen, given that China remains the largest swing factor in global iron ore pricing. Watch specifically for any sequential slowdown in Chinese steel production rates, as that would pressure NMDC's realisations directly and could undercut the revenue acceleration thesis that the factor screen is flagging. If the data surprises positively, it would reinforce the HIGH ATTENTION reading across the three metals names currently on the screen, NMDC, JSWSTEEL, and COALINDIA.

WEEK IN SUMMARY

SECTION 4 - BRIEF SUMMARY The week's key observation is that low volatility, positive FII flows, and a cluster of cheap-PE metals names in RSI recovery zones are converging into a quietly constructive setup for long-term research work. For a 30% bracket investor, the most tax-rational action right now is to deepen research on HIGH ATTENTION names like NMDC rather than trade reactively, keeping the 12-month LTCG clock firmly in mind before initiating any new position. This is personal opinion and not financial advice.

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MODEL TRACK RECORD

Factor model backtest: 2020–2025 (5-year walk-forward simulation)

Personal research note: The factor model underlying these observations was backtested on NSE stocks. Past simulation results do not guarantee future outcomes. This is not investment advice.

Metric	Model	Nifty 500
Total return (5yr)	+288.7%	+96.7%
Annualised return	+31.2% p.a.	~19.3% p.a.
Annual alpha vs index	+16.7% p.a.	—
Win rate (A/B grade trades)	48%	—
Avg tax on gains (30% bracket)	0.0% (LTCG optimised)	Up to 30% (slab rate)
Total simulated trades	180	—

Best simulated trade: MUTHOOTFIN +66.0% (2020-04-01) | Backtest note: uses approximate historical data.

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